



Production Standards + Staff Brief

Operational guide for donuts, all-beef kolaches, stuffed rolls, community feedback and future bakery automation

madebutter. is part bakery, part product lab. This document is the working standard for how the team builds consistent products, keeps production fresh, uses cold storage intelligently and turns community ideas into repeatable menu items. It is designed to evolve as recipes, equipment, staffing, packaging and demand become real.

Working draft. Not a final recipe book, HACCP plan, equipment schedule or local compliance document.

1. Operating Philosophy

The madebutter. kitchen should feel like a small, exacting product lab with the warmth of a bakery. The customer sees a clean menu and beautiful packaging. The staff sees defined systems, tight prep, chilled components, repeatable finishing and clear accept/reject standards.

THE CORE STANDARD

Every item should be treated as a product, not just a recipe. A product has a defined base, portion, shape, filling, finish, photo reference, package format, production window and quality target.

Variety comes from flavor development. Consistency comes from controlling the base forms. Donuts, kolaches and stuffed rolls should all have a stable shape language before the menu expands.

FRESH AS POSSIBLE

Prep ahead only when it protects quality. Retard doughs, chill fillings, freeze molded inserts and bake or fry fresh when the product is best served fresh.

REPEATABLE FIRST

A product is not approved just because it tastes good. It must look like the photo, package cleanly, hold during service and be trainable for staff.

The standard is simple: if a product cannot be made again tomorrow by the same process and photographed beside the approved reference without looking like a different item, it is still in testing.

2. Community Suggestions + Product Lab Loop

madebutter. should invite the community into the flavor lab without letting the menu become chaotic. Suggestions are welcome, repeated ideas are tracked and the best ideas move through a test path before they ever become a menu item.

Stage	What happens	Staff standard
1. Suggestion	Customers submit flavor ideas, fillings, wood-smoked meat ideas, donut glazes, vegan requests, coffee pairings or seasonal ingredients.	Collect the idea without judging it at the counter. Do not promise a launch date.
2. Sort	Ideas are tagged by family: milk donut, mochi ring, old-fashioned, cruller, fritter, kolache, breakfast roll, lunch roll, drink or retail.	Keep every suggestion inside a product family so it can be tested cleanly.
3. Test	Small test batches are made with notes on ingredient cost, prep time, hold quality, look, packaging and repeatability.	Photograph every test on white paper. Taste is only one score.
4. Staff vote	Team reviews eating quality, appearance, production risk and customer fit.	A good idea that is hard to execute stays in development.
5. Customer drop	Approved tests can run as limited drops or order-ahead specials.	Collect reactions and sell-through. Avoid permanent menu creep.
6. Product spec	Winning items receive a spec sheet and file name before becoming part of the rotation.	No spec sheet, no official item.

SUGGESTION AREA STANDARD

The suggestion area should feel open and playful. People can send as many suggestions as they want. The form should ask for product family, flavor idea, dietary notes, local ingredient idea and whether the customer wants to be credited if the idea becomes a drop.

The community can inspire the menu. The product lab protects the quality.

3. Photo Match Standard

The visual goal is inspired by the exactness of Japanese bakery systems: what is shown should match what the customer receives as closely as possible. Photography is not decoration. It is the product standard.

Standard	Meaning	Reject when
Shape match	The product matches the approved shape, height, width and silhouette.	The item is collapsed, stretched, undersized or shaped like a different product.
Finish match	Glaze coverage, dip line, drizzle, speckle, half dip and topping placement match the photo.	The glaze is too thin, too heavy, smeared or placed incorrectly.
Portion match	Dough weight, filling weight and finish weight stay within approved range.	The product looks skimpy, overfilled or unpredictable.
Package match	The product fits the intended sleeve, paper, box or retail pack without crushing or leaking.	The product smears the package or cannot be displayed cleanly.
Service match	The item still looks right after normal service handling.	It only looks good for the photo and fails in real service.

PRODUCT PHOTO RULE

Every approved item should have a whole photo, close detail photo, package photo and optional bite or cut view. These become training references, menu references and web assets.

4. Main Production Zones

The kitchen should be organized as three main workflows. These zones can share equipment when needed, but the staff should think of them as separate lanes with separate prep rules.

Zone	Purpose	Core work	Key controls
Donut area	Fried product workflow.	Mix, rest, cut, proof, fry, cool, fill, glaze, finish and rack donuts.	Proofing, fryer temp, oil quality, glaze viscosity, visual match.
Bakery area	Baked product workflow.	Croissant kolaches, base rolls, stuffed rolls, par-bake tests, bake-off and cooling.	Dough temp, lamination quality, proof, bake color, seal strength.
Handling + fillings area	Cooked components and inserts.	Veg prep, meat prep, smoked fillings, sauces, minced inserts, molded tubes and chilled/frozen components.	Separation, food safety, cooling, labeling, thaw schedule, allergen control.

VEGETARIAN SIDE Dedicated prep surface, tools and storage path for vegetables, dairy-free items, vegan maple sausage, sauces and non-meat fillings. This protects vegan and vegetarian product integrity.	MEAT SIDE Dedicated prep surface, tools and storage path for smoked meats, all-beef sausage, brisket, beef fillings and mixed meat inserts. This keeps meat work controlled and traceable.
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5. Freshness, Refrigeration + Freezer Intelligence

Cold storage is not a shortcut. It is a quality tool. The goal is to prepare components at the right moment, chill them safely, hold them correctly and finish the final product fresh. Smart refrigeration lets the kitchen feel fresh in the morning without forcing every component to be made from zero during the rush.

Component	Preferred path	Why it matters
Doughs	Mix, portion and retard when appropriate. Bring to working temp before proof or final shaping.	Controls fermentation, improves schedule and keeps morning production focused.
Glazes + creams	Make in controlled batches, label, refrigerate and warm or loosen to spec before finishing.	Keeps finish consistent and prevents rushed glaze texture.
Kolache fillings	Cook or portion ahead, refrigerate overnight and bake fresh in the morning.	Keeps morning bake-off fast and consistent.
Stuffed roll inserts	Cook fully, reduce moisture, mold into tubes, chill or semi-freeze, then refrigerate to temper before dough wrapping.	Firm inserts are easier to place, seal and bake evenly.
Extra inserts	Freeze backup molds when production exceeds next-day need. Move to refrigerator before use so they temper safely.	Prevents waste while keeping texture controlled.

INSERT MOLD STANDARD
Fillings should be cooked fully before they ever go into dough. They are minced, reduced or bound so the texture is moist but not watery. Then the filling is portioned into long molds or tubes and chilled until firm enough to handle. The ideal insert is firm, clean and sliceable when placed into dough. It should not be frozen rock solid at bake time unless testing proves the center heats safely and the dough bakes correctly.

6. Daily Production Rhythm

Window	Focus	Output
Previous day	Smoke meats, cook fillings, make glazes, prep doughs, mold inserts, label cold storage and set the next-day bake/fry plan.	Ready-to-finish components.
Early morning	Fire off proofed donuts, bake kolaches, bake rolls, finish glazes and set the display standard.	Fresh opening product.
Service	Refresh controlled batches, track sell-through, protect photo match and avoid overloading the case.	Consistent customer experience.
Afternoon	Start next-day prep, test small batches, review suggestions and set production counts.	Tomorrow gets easier.
Close	Clean equipment, filter oil if needed, label all product, discard anything outside hold standard and reset the lab.	Clean start for the next day.

7. Donut Area Workflow

Donuts are the main visual system. The donut area should operate like a precise finishing station with two linked paths: dough production and finish production. The two paths come together only when the donut is cool, stable and ready for glaze or filling.

Family	Production standard	Finish standard
Milk rings	Raised ring, same size across flavors, fried fresh and cooled before dipping.	Full top dip. Smooth coverage, clean edge and flavor color matched to reference.
Mochi rings	Airy mochi-style ring with defined bubble structure.	Glossy dip. Bubble form must stay visible after glaze.
Old-fashioneds	Craggy ring with controlled ridges.	Thin glaze should sit into ridges without drowning the shape.
Cream filled	Round filled donut with no hole.	Filled to spec, light finish, no blowouts and no smeared sides.
Milk bars	Long-john style bar, consistent length and height.	Full top dip with restrained drizzle or splatter.
Half-dipped crullers	French cruller ring with clean ridges.	Right-side half dip only. The undipped side stays visible.
Fritters	Hand-formed craggy shape with visible fruit or pantry inclusions.	Glossy glaze, controlled irregularity and no raw pockets.

DONUT APPROVAL RULE

Do not approve a donut flavor unless the glaze can be made to the same color, thickness and shine repeatedly. The flavor should taste clear, but the finished look must also read clearly from the case, the website and the package.

8. Croissant Kolache Workflow

Kolaches are a base product family. The three launch kolaches create the starting standard, then second-tier kolaches can add other cheeses, fillings and seasonal builds without changing the core shape.

Launch base	Position	Standard
All-beef sausage	Base meat kolache.	Croissant-style wrap, all-beef sausage, clean seal, even bake and no grease pooling.
All-beef jalapeno cheddar	Base spicy meat kolache.	Same size as original with two jalapeno rounds visible as the visual cue.
Vegan maple sausage with dairy-free cheese	Base plant-based kolache.	Maple-smoked savory direction, dairy-free cheese and protected vegetarian handling path.

KOLACHE PREP STANDARD

Kolaches should be made and refrigerated for the next day when that gives better control. The morning standard is fresh bake-off, not morning chaos.

Future testing should explore par-baked or partially staged kolaches so high volume can be finished quickly while still smelling and eating fresh.

9. Stuffed Roll System

Stuffed rolls are the savory product platform. The outside stays simple, soft, glossy and repeatable. The inside carries the smoke, sauce, vegetable work, cheese, spice and seasonal ideas.

BASE ROLL DIRECTION

The base roll should sit between Japanese milk bread, koppe-pan, a soft hoagie and a savory kolache bun. It should be slightly sweet, lightly enriched, strong enough to hold hot fillings and clean enough to package.

Step	Process	Control point
1. Cook	Smoke meats, cook vegetables and build sauces fully before molding.	No raw high-risk fillings inside dough.
2. Reduce	Cook juices, sauces and vegetables down until the filling is moist but not watery.	Watery fillings cause leaks, gummy centers and weak seams.
3. Mince or texture	Test grinder, knife mince, blender pulse, chopped vegetables, shredded meat and sliced vegetable formats.	The texture must eat well and fill evenly.
4. Bind	Use cheese, reduced jus, potato starch, mushroom reduction, dairy-free cheese or thick sauce only when needed.	Binders should support the filling, not make it pasty.
5. Mold	Portion into silicone molds, sleeve molds or tube molds.	Every insert should have a weight and length target.
6. Chill or freeze	Chill for near-term use. Freeze extras. Move frozen inserts to refrigeration before production so they temper.	Firm enough to handle, not dangerously cold in the center.
7. Wrap + seal	Wrap dough around the insert and seal tightly.	No gaps, weak seams or exposed filling.
8. Proof + bake	Proof until relaxed and bake to glossy golden with safe internal temperature.	The roll must bake evenly without leaking.

The smoked meat program should be treated like a flavor library. If three briskets are smoked, one can become a classic brisket cheddar pepper insert, one can become a Japanese-style beef insert and one can become a seasonal test. The base process stays the same. The insert changes.

10. Vegetarian + Meat Handling Standards

The handling area is split so vegetarian work and meat work do not cross. This is about product integrity, food safety and trust. The final compliance details should be reviewed locally, but the operating habit starts now.

Area	Tools	Storage	Staff behavior
Vegetarian side	Dedicated boards, knives, containers, gloves and smallwares when possible.	Clearly labeled vegetarian and vegan components above or separate from meat items.	Change gloves, clean surfaces and keep vegan/dairy-free work protected.
Meat side	Dedicated meat boards, knives, mixer bowls, smoker trays and insert molds.	Raw and cooked meats are separated. Cooked inserts are labeled by date, batch and use window.	Do not bring meat tools into vegetarian work. Do not mix prep paths.
Shared equipment	Shared mixers, blenders, scales or ovens require cleaning steps before switching categories.	Use labeled containers and covered storage.	Sequence production from cleanest to messiest when practical.

TESTING TEXTURE

Stuffed roll fillings should be tested in multiple textures: fine mince, rough chop, pulled meat, sliced vegetables, blended sauce and vegetable dice. The winning texture is the one that eats best, holds shape, does not leak and repeats cleanly.

11. Equipment + Lab Standard

The kitchen should be small but serious. Top-of-the-line equipment only matters if it is clean, calibrated and maintained. The standard is closer to a high-end dining kitchen than a casual bakery back room.

Equipment class	Standard	Daily check
Fryer	Stable temperature, clean oil, defined fry time and basket load.	Temp check, oil quality, filter schedule and safety reset.
Proofing + refrigeration	Controlled fermentation, stable cold holding and labeled racks.	Temps logged, doors sealed, no unlabeled product.
Ovens	Even bake, proper steam or humidity path if used and accurate temp.	Preheat verified, hot spots noted and bake color checked.
Mixer + sheeter	Dough development and lamination consistency.	Cleaned, inspected and kept free of dried dough.
Smoker	Wood flavor testing, safe cooking and consistent batch notes.	Wood, time, temp and meat batch recorded.
Molds + jigs	Repeatable insert shape, donut size, roll length and package fit.	Clean, counted and stored by product family.

MAINTENANCE CULTURE

Equipment should always look ready for inspection. Clean equipment is part of the brand. Broken, dirty, uncalibrated or improvised equipment creates inconsistent products and should be fixed before production expands.

12. Sourcing + Flavor Development

madebutter. should source more locally where it improves quality, story and reliability. Local sourcing should not make the menu fragile. The product lab standard is to test substitutions before committing to them.

LOCAL INGREDIENT PATH

Use local fruit, peppers, dairy, flour, honey, beef, coffee partners or seasonal farm drops when they can be purchased consistently or clearly positioned as a limited run.

FLAVOR LIBRARY PATH

Build a repeatable pantry of glazes, smoked woods, creams, reductions, sauces, spice blends and dairy-free components that can support many product families.

Test area	Questions to answer
Wood smoke	Which woods pair with brisket, beef, vegan maple sausage, mushrooms and peppers without overpowering the dough?
Vegetable cuts	Which items should be diced, sliced, minced, roasted, blended or left visible?
Sauce thickness	What texture holds inside a roll without making the dough wet?
Glaze color	Can the glaze color repeat across batches and still taste natural?
Dietary builds	Can vegan or dairy-free products be protected operationally and still taste like madebutter.?

13. Packaging + Retail Direction

Packaging should stay clean, simple and travel-ready. This brief only hints at packaging and retail because those systems deserve their own document. The production standard, however, should already consider whether a product can survive its package.

Format	Use	Production requirement
Individual sleeve	Donuts, old-fashioned and single pastries.	No heavy smearing. Product should slide in and out cleanly.
Tall sleeve	Bars, long johns and longer items.	Product length and sleeve depth must be matched.
Display box	Mixed donuts, kolaches, fritters and customer orders.	Items should be sized consistently so the box looks intentional.
Future retail	Frozen or chilled stuffed rolls, pantry goods and packaged drops.	Requires label, date, instructions, hold standards and food safety review.

14. Staff Standards + Training

Staff training should make the product system feel clear. The goal is not to make every person memorize every future flavor. The goal is to teach the base families, the photo standard, the cold storage system and the rules for testing.

Role habit	Standard
Document the batch	Record weights, times, temps, batch date, staff initials and notes.
Photograph before judging	White paper photo first. Do not rely only on memory.
Protect the system	New ideas must fit a product family or become a planned test.
Call out defects	Leaks, smears, poor proof, bad glaze, wrong size and weak seals are learning data.
Keep the lab clean	A clean station is part of the product. Reset before switching families.
Serve with confidence	Staff should know what is fresh today, what is limited and what is still in testing.

15. Product Spec Sheet Template

Every approved product should eventually receive a one-page spec sheet. This turns creative testing into training, pricing, photography and automation.

Field	What to record
Product name	Customer-facing name and internal file name.
Product family	Milk ring, mochi ring, old-fashioned, cruller, fritter, kolache, breakfast roll or lunch roll.
Base	Dough type, roll type, pastry type or donut form.
Filling or insert	Ingredients, cooked weight, mold size, chill or freeze path and final target texture.
Finish	Glaze, dip line, drizzle, topping, speckles, color and shine.
Weights	Dough weight, filling weight, glaze weight and finished weight.
Process	Prep window, proof time, fry or bake time, rest time and service hold.
Photo reference	Approved whole view, package view and optional bite view.
Accept/reject	Visual failures, texture failures, package failures and food safety failures.
Price notes	Food cost, labor, packaging cost and recommended customer price.

16. Asset Naming + Documentation

File naming keeps the web menu, printed menu, staff notes, product photos and future training materials organized. Use lowercase only, dashes only, no spaces, no numbering and no file extensions.

Category	Example
kolaches	kolache-croissant-all-beef-jalapeno-cheddar
stuffed rolls	roll-stuffed-lunch-brisket-cheddar-pepper-bite
milk donuts	donut-milk-ring-banana-cream
old-fashioned	donut-old-fashioned-matcha-sugar
crullers	donut-cruller-chocolate-glaze-right-half-dip
fritters	donut-fritter-market-seasonal-glaze
packaging	packaging-sleeve-square-logo-front

17. Evolving Brief + Next Documents

This brief should evolve after real production starts. The first version defines the operating philosophy. The next versions should include exact formulas, station maps, equipment specs, HACCP controls, training photos and production counts.

Next brief	Purpose
Production Standards + Staff Brief v2	Add exact station checklists, photos, batch logs and final accept/reject examples.
Product Creation + Kitchen Layout Brief	Map the donut area, bakery area, vegetarian handling side, meat handling side, cold storage and traffic flow.
POS + Order Ahead Systems Brief	Define order ahead, future grab-and-go, inventory counts, customer notifications, product drops and pickup logic.
Packaging + Retail Brief	Define sleeves, boxes, labels, retail packs, frozen instructions and shelf display.
Food Safety + Cold Chain Brief	Turn the refrigeration, freezing, thawing, labeling and reheating logic into a compliance-ready control document.
Community Suggestions + Flavor Drop Brief	Define the public suggestion form, voting, staff testing and limited drop calendar.

FINAL STAFF REMINDER

The brand is playful, but the product system is serious. Keep the menu simple, test constantly, document everything and make the product match the picture as closely as possible.